

Eesha Iyer

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Education

University of Maryland <i>Master of Science, Applied Economics</i> Empirical Research, Microeconomic Analysis, Applied Macroeconomics, Program Analysis & Evaluation	College Park, MD 2023 - 2025
Indian Institute of Technology, Madras <i>Postgraduate Diploma in Data Science</i>	Chennai, India 2021-2023
University of Madras <i>Bachelor of Arts, Economics</i>	Chennai, India 2019-2022

Experience

Center for Educational Data Science and Innovation Research Analyst	College Park, MD Jan 2025 – Present
- Conducting value-added modeling (VAM) on STATA on over 1.5M student records across 300 schools to estimate the causal effects of infractions on attendance - Coordinating cross-institutional research with UMD, UC Irvine, and UNC Chapel Hill using Agile project management tools (Airtable) - Created summary memos and dashboards for district leadership, translating econometric findings into decision-ready materials. - Improved outreach yield rates by 150% using STATA to identify high-yield participant groups and deployed an automated outreach workflow that increased participant engagement and reduced staff coordination time by 6 hours/week - Conducted literature review using Zotero to synthesize studies on education policy for model design and policy relevance	
The World Bank Group Global Indicators Group Research Intern	Washington, D.C. Sept 2024 – Dec 2024
- Developed a modular Python tool to convert DOCX surveys into interactive, multi-language HTML integrated with survey tools, now widely adopted across research teams, streamlining workflows and boosting response rates by 83% - Prepared and delivered research presentation decks on regional policy bottlenecks for stakeholder events across 6 CEE countries, meeting 100% of deadlines - Created Python (Matplotlib, Seaborn) visualizations using historical project data for a published World Bank research brief	
University of Maryland College of Education Research Assistant	College Park, MD Feb 2024 – Sept 2024
- Used STATA to merge and clean over 250,000 multi-year student records from over 100 Baltimore City Public Schools, addressing missingness and integrating data from multiple sources for longitudinal analysis - Applied fixed effects and difference-in-differences models to evaluate the impact of a STEM program on student score outcomes - Collaborated with district stakeholders to resolve complex data issues and validate analytical methods throughout the project - Contributed to evidence-based decision-making by drafting reports showing a 15% increase in STEM participation	
TVS Credit Services Ltd Data & Analytics Intern	Chennai, India May 2023 - Jul 2023
- Built Power BI dashboards to monitor and communicate survey data gaps, supporting targeted collection efforts that improved data robustness by 30% and increased model accuracy by 8% - Implemented intercept and online surveys to reach underserved communities, capturing real-world data for algorithm training - Used Python to engineer segmentation features for 3 M+ users, boosting machine learning ensemble model accuracy by 14%.	

Projects

Holden (2016), Replication Project <i>University of Maryland, College Park</i>	College Park, MD Jan 2024 – May 2024
Conducted econometric replication and extended analysis using external datasets on STATA to validate and build on original study findings	
Green Spaces and Gentrification: How Community Gardens Unintentionally Displace Their Creators <i>Research Paper</i>	Mar 2025 – Aug 2025
Presented research at ICEE 2025 – Penn State Altoona on how community gardens affect urban gentrification, using Census migration APIs, and difference-in-differences to analyze ZIP-level displacement trends.	

Skills

Programming: Python (Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), STATA, R, SQL, Power BI, Excel, GitHub, SurveyCTO, Zotero
Analytical Methods: Quasi-experimental methods, Causal Inference, Mixed Methods Research, Program Evaluation, Survey Design
Data Skills: Data Harmonization and Cleaning, Feature Engineering, Model Evaluation, Data Visualization, Data Documentation
Project Management: Multi-Institutional Coordination, Stakeholder Engagement, Process Mapping, Agile, Airtable
Certifications: Agile Project Management (Atlassian), Google Data Analytics, Microsoft Azure Fundamentals